

Ernest SONG ♦ Director of Finance — Strategic Finance & ERP Transformation

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Director of Finance who bridges strategic finance and ERP transformation. I have led SAP S/4HANA go-live as a core Business Analyst, built budgeting & modeling from scratch, and rolled out strategic BI (Power BI, Cognos, QlikSense) that turns SAP data into executive decisions. My value is perspective: I have sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I pair rigorous financial modeling with change management that makes transformation stick across multi-site, multi-country operations.

Education

ESCP Business School

(#1 FT 2026)

2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR

Specialized Master's degree

Auditing and Consulting

Université Paris Nanterre

2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR

Master's degree

Management Science and Financial Control

Competencies

Strategic Finance

- Strategic finance
- Financial modeling
- Business planning
- Valuation

ERP Implementation

- SAP S/4HANA go-live
- SAP HANA migration
- SAP BPC

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Cognos
- Business Objects

Change Management

- Change transition
- RPA adoption
- Self-service BI

Financial Reporting

- IFRS reporting
- Consolidation
- Variance analysis

Data & Analytics

- SQL
- VBA
- R

Budgeting & Forecasting

- Budgeting & forecasting
- Cash flow modeling
- Variance analysis

Treasury & Financing

- Cash exposure
- Credit analysis
- Debt/equity raises

Governance & Control

- Internal control
- Regulatory reporting
- SOX context

Operations Partnering

- Operations partnering
- Cross-functional teams
- Stakeholder management

M&A / Corporate Dev

- Corporate development
- M&A integration
- Real estate acquisition

Languages

Native: French, Khmer, Teochew

Proficient: English

Basics: Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

Professional Experience

Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

Director of Finance — SAP S/4HANA Go-Live & Financial Control

- Guide the financial controlling pilot phase of the SAP S/4HANA migration, bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations as core Business Analyst.
- Deliver a budgeting & forecasting model built from scratch within a 2-week window, replacing an unreliable legacy framework to protect operational continuity.
- Automate month-end close for commodity trading, deploying PowerQuery ETL workflows that ingest 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.
- Reconcile middle-office (IVDB) data with SAP S/4HANA and simplify WDS project codes to strengthen portfolio monitoring and strategic variance analysis.

Holcim

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

Director of Finance — ERP Migration & Strategic BI Reporting

- Drive data-informed operational restructuring post-M&A to improve productivity and post-integration performance.
- Own the SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and guaranteeing system integrity for strategic consolidation reporting.
- Lead QlikSense deployment to convert SAP data into executive Business Intelligence reporting and commercial insights.
- Build rebate models (matrix and automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy and liaise with auditors on rebate matters.

Engie Tractebel

March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE

Strategic Finance Advisor — Cash Flow & Financial Modeling

- Design cash flow reporting and per-project cash exposure to support treasury and financing decisions.
- Model financing needs, perform counterpart credit analysis and impairment testing for the local entity.
- Build finance data models from SAP HANA and design Power BI strategic reporting to accelerate executive decisions.

Shurgard

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

Corporate Development — Investment & M&A Real Estate

- Manage real estate M&A including construction, redevelopment and acquisition of self-storage businesses.
- Maintain a project dashboard and initiate corporate-development initiatives that improve departmental policies.
- Design the data model and visualisation for the Investment department's Business Intelligence reporting.
- Collaborate on an AI-based pricing model to strengthen commercial margin oversight and strategic positioning.

Magnetrap

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

Interim CFO / Fundraising Consultant — Strategic Capital

- Act as interim CFO and raise strategic capital, arranging €3M in debt and equity financing.
- Build long-term business plans, cash flow projections and financial goals under P&L oversight.
- Monitor performance against plan and implement corrective actions to protect profitability.
- Prepare operating-results reports and maintain financial models for ongoing strategic planning.

Tobania

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

Director Business Process Automation — RPA & Self-Service BI

- Roll out a citizen-developer model using RPA and self-service BI, defining pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Drive business development across marketing, pre-sales and sales to expand finance-operations offerings.
- Implement process optimisation, standardisation and harmonisation to improve efficiency and profitability.
- Establish change management structures to accelerate adoption of new processes and technology.

Soap collect

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

Founder — Non-Profit & Sustainability

- Establish a non-profit providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Partner with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning and scale impact.

Vinci Airports

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling

- Deliver value creation with a valuation at 4 times acquisition cost across a concession portfolio.
- Deploy airport operations across 50+ locations in multiple countries while managing accounting.
- Build long-term financial business models incorporating macroeconomic impact, CapEx and concession valuation.
- Negotiate concession contract extensions and improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Manage financial reporting in line with BE-GAAP standards across operations.

Rexel

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

Reporting Consolidation Manager — IFRS Strategic Reporting

- Lead IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Spearhead SAP BPC and Cognos integration to strengthen strategic consolidation reporting.
- Perform annual budgeting, monthly forecasting and variance analysis versus budgeted results.
- Lead the strategic planning process for the organisation.

Financial Auditor Supervisor — Governance & Compliance

- *Audit financial statements under various accounting standards, including SOX process testing.*
- *Review financial modeling for long-term Public-Private Partnership contracts.*
- *Certify FP7 grant agreements and lead supervised audit teams.*
- *Develop partnerships and identify new markets to support business growth.*
- *Cover main sectors: construction, real estate, water distribution, parcels distribution, security and healthcare.*

ICM - Brain & Spine Institute*November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR***Deputy CFO Trainee — Budgeting & Internal Control**

- *Implement the budget system and prepare business plans for scientific teams.*
- *Establish internal control for purchasing and donation processes and manage bank reconciliation.*
- *Prepare the institutional audit supporting certification by the “Comité de la Charte”.*